WIZARD SUBCLASS · D&D 2024

Blue Mage

Blue Mages learn magic from monsters: by surviving their attacks, or by studying what's left of them.

V0.1 PLAYTEST ARCANE TRADITION: BLUE MAGIC INSPIRED BY FINAL FANTASY

Inspired by the saber-wielding Blue Mage of *Final Fantasy Tactics Advance 2*, they fight on the front line because that's where the lessons are. Blue Magic uses existing spells from any class's list; the Blue Magic table maps monster abilities to those spells.

FEATURES

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LEVEL 3

Saber Training

You gain proficiency with Martial melee weapons that lack the Two-Handed and Heavy properties, and you can use such a weapon as a Spellcasting Focus for your Wizard spells.

LEVEL 3

Blue Magic

You can learn spells from any class's spell list, but only from creatures. Spells learned this way are your Blue Magic spells. They count as Wizard spells for you, and you record them in your spellbook at no gold cost. You learn Blue Magic in two ways:

- **Learn by Being Hit.** When a creature hits you with an ability on the Blue Magic table, or forces you to make a saving throw against one, you can record the matching spell when the encounter ends, provided you don't have the Unconscious condition.
- **Learn by Study.** During a Short or Long Rest, you can spend 1 hour studying the remains of a creature and make an Intelligence (Arcana) check (DC 10 + the creature's CR). On a success, you record one spell that creature can teach. A creature's remains can teach only one spell, and only one attempt can be made on them; to learn more of a creature's Blue Magic, you must find another one. The remains must be largely intact.

You can record Blue Magic of any level, but you can't cast a spell until you have spell slots of its level.

LEVEL 3

Azure Repertoire

You can prepare a number of additional Blue Magic spells equal to your Proficiency Bonus. These don't count against the number of spells you can prepare.

LEVEL 6

Extra Attack

You can attack twice instead of once whenever you take the Attack action on your turn. You can replace one of those attacks with a casting of one of your Wizard cantrips that has a casting time of an action.

LEVEL 6

Libra

As a Bonus Action, choose a creature you can see within 60 feet of yourself. You learn its damage Vulnerabilities, Resistances, and Immunities, its Condition Immunities, and which Blue Magic spells it can teach you. You can use this feature a number of times equal to your Intelligence modifier (minimum of once), and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

LEVEL 10

I've Felt This Before

When a creature uses an ability whose matching spell is recorded in your spellbook, you have Advantage on saving throws against that ability and Resistance to its damage.

LEVEL 14

Azure Retort

When you're hit by a Blue Magic ability, or fail a saving throw against one, you can take a Reaction to cast the matching spell at that creature without expending a spell slot, provided the spell is recorded in your spellbook and you can cast spells of its level. Once you use this feature, you can't use it again until you finish a Long Rest unless you expend a level 5 spell slot to restore your use of it.

Blue Magic Table

The DM has final say on which abilities can teach which spells. The tables below are suggestions, not a complete list; DMs are encouraged to map other creatures and abilities the same way.

- **Spellcasters.** A creature with the Spellcasting action can teach any spell it lists. Those spells don't need table entries.
- **Innate abilities.** Everything else uses the tables below, organized by creature type. The same ability can appear at several levels, depending on the creature's size and age.
- **Study only.** Abilities that don't hit you or force you to save, such as a will-o'-wisp turning invisible, can be learned only by study.

- **CR cap.** A creature can teach Blue Magic of a level no higher than half its CR, rounded up. A CR 0 or 1/2 creature teaches only cantrips.
- **Beyond the cap.** You can learn a spell up to the creature's signature level even when it exceeds the CR cap, but it takes an Intelligence (Arcana) check at DC 10 + the creature's CR, plus 5 for each level the spell exceeds the cap. When studying, this replaces the normal study DC. When learning by being hit, you make the check when the encounter ends; on a failure, you can still try again later by studying the creature. Once you have spell slots of the spell's level, the +5 penalty no longer applies, so a medusa can still teach *Flesh to Stone* to a Blue Mage who can already cast level 6 spells.
- **Kindred Summons.** A creature can teach the Summon spell matching its creature type (*Summon Beast*, *Summon Undead*, *Summon Fiend*, and so on), subject to the normal CR cap.
- **Warrior Techniques.** Martial humanoids teach fighting techniques, mapped to smite, strike, and other combat spells from the Paladin and Ranger lists. A DM can map any warrior NPC's signature move the same way.

Dragons

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURES	SPELL	LEVEL
Wing buffet	Wyrmlings, young dragons	*Thunderwave*	1
Small breath weapon	Wyrmlings	*Dragon's Breath*	2
Frightful Presence	Adult and older dragons	*Fear*	3
Line breath (lightning)	Blue and bronze dragons	*Lightning Bolt*	3
Cone breath (cold)	White and silver dragons	*Cone of Cold*	5
Massive breath (fire)	Ancient red dragon	*Incendiary Cloud*	8

Beasts

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Mimicry	Raven (0)	*Minor Illusion*	0
Venomous bite	Poisonous snake (1/8)	*Poison Spray*	0
Ink cloud	Giant octopus (1)	*Fog Cloud*	1
Webbing	Giant spider (1)	*Ensnaring Strike*	1

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Webbing	Giant spider (1)	*Web* (beyond the cap)	2
Trampling charge	Elephant (4)	*Thunderous Smite*	1

Undead

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Chilling touch	Shadow (1/2)	*Chill Touch*	0
Wisp shock	Will-o'-wisp (2)	*Shocking Grasp*	0
Undead Fortitude	Zombie (1/4)	*False Life* (beyond the cap)	1
Life Drain	Specter (1)	*Inflict Wounds*	1
Horrifying Visage	Ghost (4)	*Cause Fear*	1
Paralyzing claws	Ghoul (1)	*Hold Person* (beyond the cap)	2
Dreadful Glare	Mummy (3)	*Hold Person*	2
Fading from sight	Will-o'-wisp (2)	*Invisibility* (beyond the cap)	2
Life Drain	Wight (3)	*Vampiric Touch* (beyond the cap)	3
Create Specter	Wraith (5)	*Animate Dead*	3
Mist form	Vampire (13)	*Gaseous Form*	3
Charm	Vampire (13)	*Dominate Person*	5
Mummy Rot	Mummy lord (15)	*Contagion*	5

Monstrosities

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Luring Song	Harpy (1)	*Charm Person*	1
Shapechanger	Mimic (2)	*Disguise Self*	1
Darkness Aura	Darkmantle (1/2)	*Darkness* (beyond the cap)	2
Acid Spray	Ankheg (2)	*Melf's Acid Arrow* (beyond the cap)	2
Displacement	Displacer beast (3)	*Blur*	2
Ethereal Jaunt	Phase spider (3)	*Misty Step*	2

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Webbing	Phase spider (3)	*Web*	2
Fire breath	Chimera (6)	*Fireball*	3
Lightning breath	Behir (11)	*Lightning Bolt*	3
Petrifying Gaze	Medusa (6)	*Flesh to Stone* (beyond the cap)	6

Fiends

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Fetid Cloud	Dretch (1/4)	*Poison Spray*	0
Poison sting	Imp (1)	*Ray of Sickness*	1
Scare	Quasit (1)	*Cause Fear*	1
Fire breath	Hell hound (3)	*Burning Hands*	1
Invisibility	Imp (1)	*Invisibility* (beyond the cap, study only)	2
Charm	Succubus/Incubus (4)	*Suggestion*	2
Hurl Flame	Barbed devil (5)	*Scorching Ray*	2
Stench	Hezrou (8)	*Stinking Cloud*	3
Horror Nimbus	Nalfeshnee (13)	*Fear*	3
Fire Aura	Balor (19)	*Fire Shield*	4
Nightmare Haunting	Night hag (5)	*Dream* (beyond the cap)	5

Humanoids

Humanoids with the Spellcasting action teach the spells they cast. The entries below cover martial humanoids; creature names are placeholders for whichever warrior stat blocks you use.

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Parry	Knight (3)	*Shield*	1
Leadership	Knight (3)	*Heroism*	1
Shield Bash	Gladiator (5)	*Thunderous Smite*	1

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Poisoned blade	Assassin (8)	*Ray of Sickness*	1
Volley	Archer-type humanoids (3)	*Hail of Thorns*	1
Brute Strength	Duergar (1)	*Enlarge/Reduce* (beyond the cap)	2
Precise Strike	Gladiator (5)	*Branding Smite*	2
Sneak strike	Assassin (8)	*Invisibility* (study only)	2

Aberrations

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Devour Intellect	Intellect devourer (2)	*Mind Sliver*	0
Sleep Ray	Beholder (13)	*Sleep*	1
Paralyzing tentacles	Chuul (4)	*Hold Person*	2
Phantasms	Cloaker (8)	*Mirror Image*	2
Moan	Cloaker (8)	*Fear*	3
Slowing Ray	Beholder (13)	*Slow*	3
Charm Ray	Beholder (13)	*Charm Monster*	4
Gibbering	Gibbering mouther (2)	*Confusion* (beyond the cap)	4
Telekinetic Ray	Beholder (13)	*Telekinesis*	5
Enslave	Aboleth (10)	*Dominate Person*	5
Mind Blast	Mind flayer (7)	*Synaptic Static* (beyond the cap)	5
Disintegration Ray	Beholder (13)	*Disintegrate*	6
Death Ray	Beholder (13)	*Finger of Death*	7
Antimagic Cone	Beholder (13)	*Antimagic Field* (beyond the cap)	8

Constructs

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Sleep-inducing bite	Homunculus (0)	*Sleep* (beyond the cap)	1
Shield	Shield guardian (7)	*Warding Bond*	2

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Haste	Clay golem (9)	*Haste*	3
Slow	Stone golem (10)	*Slow*	3
Poison Breath	Iron golem (16)	*Cloudkill*	5

Elementals

Genies (djinni, efreeti, and others) are spellcasters and teach the spells they cast.

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Frost breath	Ice mephit (1/2)	*Ray of Frost*	0
Fire breath	Magma mephit (1/2)	*Fire Bolt*	0
Blinding breath	Dust mephit (1/2)	*Blindness/Deafness* (beyond the cap)	2
Whirlwind	Air elemental (5)	*Gust of Wind*	2
Heated Body	Salamander (5)	*Heat Metal*	2
Earth Glide	Earth elemental, Xorn (5)	*Meld into Stone*	3
Fire Form	Fire elemental (5)	*Fire Shield* (beyond the cap)	4
Invisibility	Invisible stalker (6)	*Greater Invisibility* (beyond the cap, study only)	4

Celestials

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Healing Touch	Unicorn (5)	*Cure Wounds*	1
Shimmering Shield	Unicorn (5)	*Shield of Faith*	1
Angelic Weapons	Deva (10)	*Divine Smite*	1
Teleport	Unicorn (5)	*Dimension Door* (beyond the cap)	4
Change Shape	Deva (10)	*Polymorph* (study only)	4
Healing Touch	Planetar (16)	*Heal*	6

Fey

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Fey Charm	Dryad (1)	*Charm Person*	1
Illusory Appearance	Green hag (3)	*Disguise Self*	1
Sleep arrows	Sprite (1/4)	*Sleep* (beyond the cap)	1
Teleport	Blink dog (1/4)	*Misty Step* (beyond the cap)	2
Invisible Passage	Green hag (3)	*Invisibility* (study only)	2

Giants

Catapult is a legacy spell (*Xanathar's Guide to Everything*) with no 2024 reprint, so it remains usable alongside the 2024 rules.

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Thrown rock	Hill giant (5)	*Catapult*	1
Thrown boulder	Stone giant (7)	*Shatter*	2
Evil Eye	Fomorian (8)	*Bestow Curse*	3
Lightning Strike	Storm giant (13)	*Call Lightning*	3
Ice blasts	Frost giant (8)	*Ice Storm*	4
Flaming strikes	Fire giant (9)	*Wall of Fire*	4

Oozes

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Corrosive pseudopod	Gray ooze (1/2)	*Acid Splash*	0
Split	Ochre jelly (2)	*Mirror Image* (beyond the cap)	2
Acidic body	Black pudding (4)	*Melf's Acid Arrow*	2

Plants

Thunderclap is a legacy spell (*Xanathar's Guide to Everything*) with no 2024 reprint.

ABILITY	EXAMPLE CREATURE (CR)	SPELL	LEVEL
Shriek	Shrieker (0)	*Thunderclap*	0
Rotting Touch	Violet fungus (1/4)	*Chill Touch*	0
Entangling Plants	Vine blight (1/2)	*Entangle* (beyond the cap)	1
Engulf	Shambling mound (5)	*Entangle*	1
Pacifying Spores	Myconid sovereign (2)	*Calm Emotions* (beyond the cap)	2
Animate Trees	Treant (9)	*Plant Growth*	3

PLAYTEST NOTES

- **Learning pace:** is the party meeting enough teachable creatures to make a new spell feel like a regular event?
- **Study DC:** check that DC 10 + CR feels reachable at low and mid levels.
- **Off-list access:** watch for any non-Wizard spell that becomes too strong in a Wizard's hands.
- **Frontline survivability:** with no defensive feature, see whether the Blue Mage survives melee at low levels.
- **Azure Retort:** confirm a free reflected spell at level 14 isn't too swingy with high-level Blue Magic.
- **Stat block check:** verify ability names and CRs in the tables against the 2024 Monster Manual.
- **Divine Smite:** a Blue Mage with Divine Smite and Extra Attack could hit hard; watch how often devas appear and whether it dominates.

V0.1 PLAYTEST: FIRST PUBLIC RELEASE

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